Final Project Report

Project Name: The Magic of the 5 Element Sounds of the Svaram Sonorium

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A. Project Motivation as stated in the Sonic Project Synopsis:

As a Sonorium sound practitioner, my motivation is to enrich my tool box and improve my skills while offering a Sonorium session.
Another motivation is to be able to share the outcome of the research with other Sonorium practitioners and to affect the wellbeing of more and more people.

B. Project Explorations:

In the project synopsis I prepared a set of questions that I wanted to explore as part of the research project.

- How do we check and measure the effect of sound on the client?
- How do the 5 elements affect the body, emotions, mind and spiritual state?
- How do those sounds affect the brain wave state?
- What is the role of the 5 elements in a sound session?
- When and how will it be good to use them?
- When or how one shouldn't use them?

C. Work Approach & Project Achievements:

- I prepared a Project Process Plan.
- Reading materials - I have read very interesting theory:
    - Sound healing with the five elements, Daniel Perret.
    - The healing power of sound, Mitchell L. Gaynor, M.D.
- Practitioners' questionnaire -
    - I prepared 2 questionnaires which I shared with Sonorium practitioners and got answers from Joseph, Varun, Priyanjali, Tommaso, Dhruv, Vasundhara, Rupal, Niva.
    - I have interviewed Sonorium practitioners (Tommaso, Vasundhara, Robert)
- Clients' questionnaire -
    - I went through the feedback responses to Sonorium sessions from different Svaram's clients. It helped me to draft a questionnaire for clients after a session.
    - I have shared the questionnaire with many clients from which 14 have answered.
    - I have interviewed many clients.
- Practical explorations -
    - I searched for deeper understanding of the impact of the 5 elements on the client
    - I explored different ways of using those sounds, alone and in combinations with other sounds to create an impact of polarity or balance and harmony.
- Different ways to evaluate the impact of sound vibrations on the human body - I search for a list of possible ways to evaluate the impact of sound, see below.
- Muse 2 - I searched for different devices to check the physical impact on the human body, specially brainwaves. Svaram was willing to invest and bought this device. Unfortunately the device hasn't arrived yet.
    - Research protocol - I prepared a research protocol with the details of how I am going to work with the Muse 2 and a plan on how to analyze the data.
    - Candidates for the research - I have found 8 candidates who are willing to be part of the Muse 2 research as clients. They agree to have 3 sessions weekly and give me detailed feedback.
    - I will continue the research once I get the device.
- Training material -
    - I have prepared a 11 minutes video with the Sonorium 5 elements. One could get an impression of possible ways to use those instruments.
    - I have recorded 2 Sonorium practitioners using the 5 element sounds.
    - With the project in mind, I offered 2 sessions in the Sonorium training in August 2022 about the 5 element sounds and its impacts on the clients. There are videos of the classes.
    - Some parts of the project final presentation and outcome of the clients' and practitioners' questionnaires can be shared in a Sonorium training. .

D. The challenges I faced along the project:

- Moving from the Sonorium 5 element instruments to 5 elements in general brought a lot of confusion and lack of focus. I realized that I can find the 5 elements in each element and almost in each instrument. That the intention and the energy in the room make the difference and not so much the classification of the elements. I read a lot about the 5 elements in different cultures and it brought me away from the project. So it became clear that I needed to focus and the question was to focus on what. On the elements? On specific sounds? Specific instruments? While preparing my mid-project progress report, I read again my initial goals and realized that in the project synopsis I mentioned specific instruments and I felt that was my initial intention for the project and I should get back to it.

  This confusion took time and energy, and yet it was an interesting process and valuable as I could see that it was reflecting a parallel personal journey.

- Working on the practitioners questionnaire – wasn't easy at all. While putting the questions in a Google form I realize that I am not clear enough what to focus on. Is it the use of the 5 elements in a sound session in general? Or I want to focus on the impact of the natural sound instruments of the Sonorium? I felt more connected to the Sonorium and that was the initial goal. When I saw the questionnaire and the practitioners' answers, I felt it didn't reflect what I wanted to know from the practitioners. I have changed it several times and each time I went in a different direction. It helped to focus a bit more. I needed to go deeper and check again what the purpose of the survey was.

- Muse 2 has not arrived yet - unfortunately I couldn't start to measure the impact of the Sonorium 5 elements with the Muse 2, since it hasn't arrived. The plan was to start working with it at the beginning of October.

  With the flow of the project I have decided to continue interviewing clients and sound practitioners.

- Difficult to define 3 ways to play with the 5 elements – my initial idea was to define 3 different ways to use the 5 element sounds in a Sonorium session. After thinking about it and after consolidating the sound practitioners' responses (most of the practitioners work based on their intuition and not stick to a plan), I understood that it is better not to have fixed ways to use those instruments and sounds and leave it to the intuition of the practitioner. Yet, I gathered some ideas on how to play each instrument, with different mallets, and how to combine it with other sounds for creating a deeper level of impact.

E. Sonorium Practitioners Survey

Some of the questions I have asked the Sonorium practitioners are:

- How to measure the impact of the sound?
- What are the roles of the 5 elements in a sound session?
- What are the possible effects of each element?
- When and how to play the elemental sounds?
- When and how one shouldn't play them?
- What are good combinations of sounds?

At the end are some graphs presenting the outcome of some of the questions.

Research Findings

- How to measure the impact of the 5 element sounds on the client? I wanted to check the different brainwaves, blood pressure, heart rate variability etc.
    - I found a device that intends to check brainwaves, blood pressure, heart rate variability etc.
    - Another possible way to measure the impact is with an aura camera.
    - From the sound practitioners survey I found the different ways that a practitioner can check the impact on the client:
        - The practitioner's awareness. Feeling the energy of the client
        - Body language - active or passive:
            - Muscle tension in the arms and limbs
            - Inherent pulse in the body
            - Facial muscle tension - stretching and relaxing
            - Eye movement
            - Shoulder Positions
        - Tone of voice - before and after
        - Sensing the differences in client before and after the session
        - Quality and duration of breathing through the session
        - Chest breathing or diaphragm breathing
        - Sensing the client when snores - sleeping or in a high meditative space
        - When the client cries
        - Color of the white's of the eyes
        - Sharing with the client after the session
        - Post session Questionnaire

- The 5 element sounds help to:
    - Pause the mind
    - Identify/open emotional or physical blockages
    - Balance the lacking elements
    - Shake - trigger deeper reactions
    - Transform - shift the client from his comfort zone

- What is the possible effect of the 5 elements sounds on the clients?
    - **FIRE: Storm drum** - many people face old traumas, meeting dead people, facing their dark side or fears, some people feel shaken, remove bad vib, some people really like the impact and want to have more of it, some feel scared or shaken and then a relief
    - **WATER: Ocean drum, Rattles and water sound** - open blockages, balance the fear or darkness of the fire and wind elements, good to use to balance the intensity of the storm drum or wind breath. Many people feel washed with the water, helps to flow with the imagination, it relaxes and brings up sensations and good memories.
    - **EARTH: Singing stone**, works well for sacral chakra, balances the water or fire in the body, grounding and calming.
    - **Plate gong** - used for grounding, feeling safe, focused and calm.
    - **AIR: Wind breath -** some feel good, some feel cold, uncertain, challenged.
    - **ETHER:** it is very interesting to see that each Sonorium practitioner has his weather element. For some it is the voice, the sound bed, frame drum, stone, flute. It looks that the clients are affected by the practitioners' preference.
    - **My ether was Glassophone, now it is more humming/singing with the stone**- many people experience a spiritual shift, uplifting sensations, memories from past life, some people don't remember the sound. Helpful to clear and integrate a grieving process.

- When will it be good to use the 5 element sounds?
    - One should be careful with strong and shaking sounds.
    - Use it only after bringing the client to a grounded state, after a relaxing phase.
    - When the client feels safe and comfortable.
    - Use all around the room.
    - One should study and understand the 5 elements really well before using them.
    - Use when you feel comfortable and follow the reaction of the client.

- When or how one shouldn't use them?
    - Not to use it in special cases as: depressed people, pre-existing medical conditions relating to the heart, brain or the nervous system (spine included), with deep traumas, sexual abuse, and with pregnant women.

- One of the times that I believe I didn't use the 5 elements was when I had a highly depressed client, in which case my session developed around using sounds like bells, glassophone, and anything that could elevate his mind to something melodic and light, but even then I remember using the element of air, albeit in a reduced way.
- In light of the triggering nature of the 5 elements, one should always observe caution while working with clients who have.
- One shouldn't use strong sounds like the storm drum, ocean drum, rattles, wind at the beginning or at the end of a session. It should come gradually when the client is ready.
- One should be very careful with strong/loud sounds around the head (rattles, frame drum, wind breath, ocean drum)
- Sometimes an element can possess you and you may overdo the element, it's important to be reverential to the elements while using them.
- Without a deep understanding of the elements and the impact on the physical, etheric and astral body using the elements approach is best left unattended.

- **Combinations of Sounds:**

Combinations of sound in a sound session can bring balance, especially while using the 5 elements. For example to balance the fire or air element with water or earth. If we want to reach intensity we have to do it carefully and balance it with other elements.

Combination of sounds can create deeper impact by allowing either polarities or harmony and balance.

Combination of sounds sound good and make it more interesting for the practitioner as well for the client.

Here are some tips for a practitioner:

- Combine sounds from opposite side of the room (gong and resonators, plate bells and tubular bells, stormdrum and rattles, stone and storm drum)
- Play with polarities (tubular resonators and soft rattles or pulse tubes, storm and water, frame drum - ocarina)
- When playing with another practitioner it is recommended that:
  - One of the practitioner is leading, the other one is following
  - Listening to each other
  - Give space for the other
  - Call and response

        - Play with polarities of the elements and around the room
        - Complimentary

Some sound combinations can be:

- Ocean drum - wind breath, soft rattles, storm drum
- Storm drum - rattles, plate gong with rubber mallet, stone, tubular resonators
- Stone - plate gong with rubber mallet, storm drum, frame drum
- Frame drum - ocarina, flute, soft rattles, or tapping with the foot on the rattles
- Glassophone - pulse tubes, bells, single resonators, tubular bells
- Voice - bed, stone, drum, gong, resonators
- Bed and Shruti Plates
- Stone, Storm Drum and Glassophone alternating
- Water with Glassophone

F. Sonorium Clients' Feedback

The clients were asked question such as:

- Regarding their receptivity during the session
- If they had experienced an emotional release due to the sound session
- If they felt any specific sound in a specific part of their body
- If they noticed a positive change in the content of thoughts after the session
- If gained new insights due to the session
- If felt more balanced and centered after the session
- If felt a strong connection to themselves due to the Session
- What are the sounds they particularly liked
- What are the sounds they particularly didn't like
- How much they liked the sounds of the different instruments and what was the impact
- If they felt a change with regard to their intention

At the end are some graphs presenting the outcome of some of the questions.

Clients comments on the different instruments:

- Water sound - refreshing, flowing, playful, uplifting, light, happy, good memories, childhood, relaxing.
- Ocean drum - helps to disconnect from the mind, people go into higher spaces, waves crashing to my legs, washing, shower rain, dancing in the rain, relaxing, good memories with water/ocean/rain, memories of good relationship, opened emotional blockage, happy, people felt it in the heart and haid
- Storm drum - people either really like or feel their dark side, fears, feeling stuck, need to be shaken, dead people faces, memories of difficult situations (difficult relationship with the father, couldn't take her robot with her when she was 4 years

old, felt being stalked by a big cat or frightening person), opens emotional blockages, opens up body cells, out of sync, flinched, overwrought
    - Wind breath - also brings a good feeling or meets the client with fear and dark side, uncertainty, feeling cold.
    - Bed - removed blocks, relaxing, balancing, centering, a baby in mother's hands,
    - Glassophone - shaking chills, spiritual experience, breakthrough, uplifting, open, feeling inner organs, memory of my past life , access to higher dimensions.
    - Plate gong - grounding, feeling safe, shaking if too strong,
    - Singing stone - relieves physical pain, feeling the vibrations, calming, grounding - returning to earth, strong positive impact, calming, feels like traveling in space, brings to higher spaces, feeling good. People felt in the lower charas and legs

G. Training Materials

- In July and August I gave a few classes to Svaram's clients about the 5 elements in the Sonorium. They found it very valuable as sound practitioners even though some of them are not working with the Sonorium. It includes the following:
    - Introduce the 5 element instruments
    - Possible ways of play, different dynamics and intensities
    - How to balance their strong impact on the client
    - The possible impacts of those sounds on the clients
    - When and how to use them
    - When and how to be careful when using them
    - Harmonious combinations of sounds
    - How to play with another facilitator

H. Highlights from the Project Documentation

- I had 2 mentor meetings with Joseph and one with Varun. Meeting notes can be found here:
    - Mentor 24.05.2022
    - Mentor 17.6.22

- Between the 23.5 till July end I have documented the progress I have done in 2 different files:
    - Weekly Progress report
    - Mid Project - Progress Report

- In August I went through a personal crisis, faced the Auroville crisis and a trauma at Svaram. I realized that since then I stopped documenting the progress of the project.

Lately, when I read the documentation I found the following from the beginning of July:

> *"Coming back from Israel after 6 weeks. A transition between 2 different worlds. I feel the need to slow down. I wish for soft landing and giving space for transition.*
>
> *It takes time to digest, understand where I am, where I am coming from, how I feel in each place and where I feel home. I feel lucky to have 2 places that feel like home and yet it takes a lot of energy to recheck where My Place is.*
>
> *So I spent time and stayed open and checked how all this is connected to my project. I realized that all this transition between 2 worlds is the air and spirit elements in my path. My process of landing and grounding here in Auroville is the earth element. The fact that I let myself flow, rest, slow down feels like the water element. Fortunately I feel very relaxed and calm from inside. The fire is still not there. I think I give it some space. Next week I will start a 3 week Tomatis practice and I guess the fire will come out then. So the fire is in the background.*
>
> *I also need a few days to land, to be here and now, before I come back to the Sonorium practice.*
>
> *Let's see how all this will affect my project. Looking forward to what comes next."*

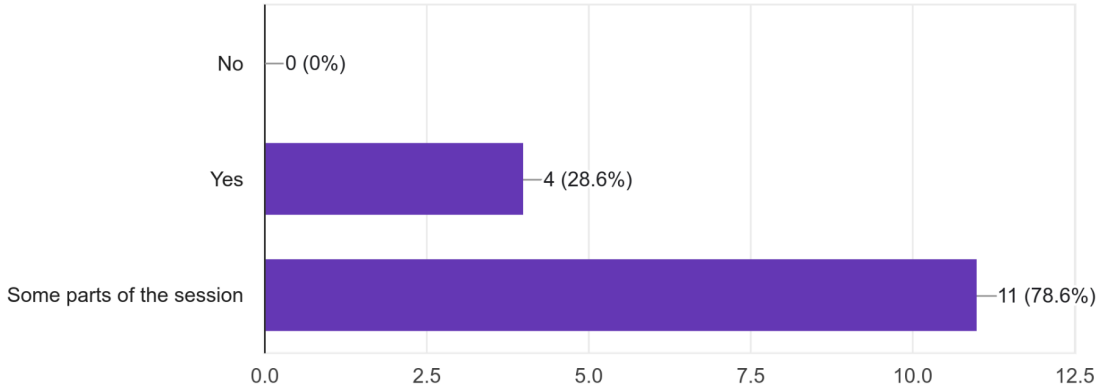
After I started Tomatis, the Fire did come, burn and had a lot of impact on me in my personal life, Auroville and Svaram. After the tragedy at Svaram I couldn't practice at the Sonorium for 10 days. I needed a break. Since then I found the Sonorium as my healing space where I can renew my energies.

I feel complete and round. I have all the 5 elements in my life, like in my project.

Some graphs from the clients' feedback:

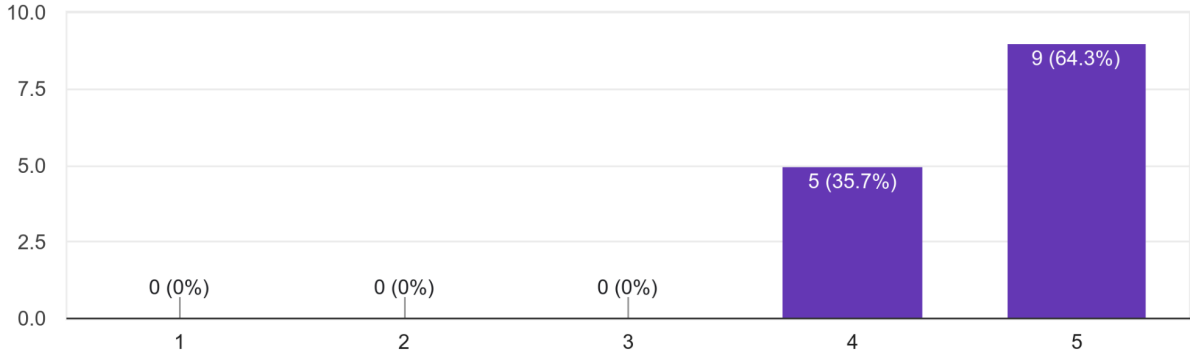
Do you remember all the parts of the session?

14 responses



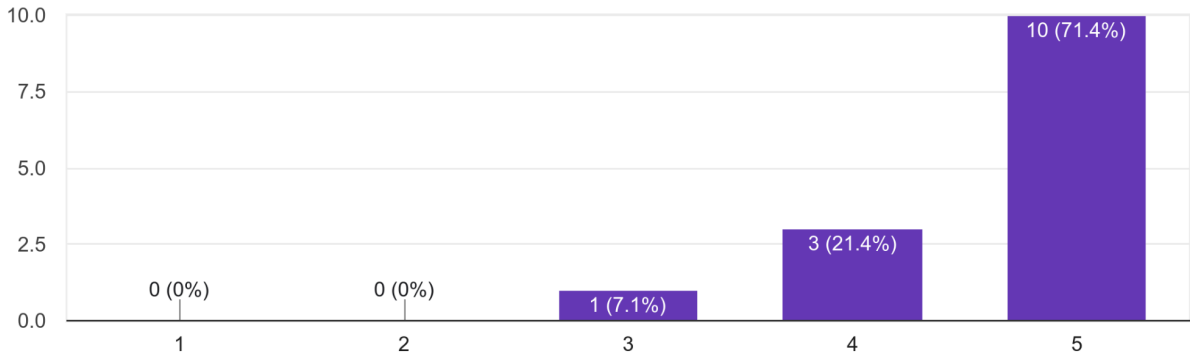
I felt very receptive during the session

14 responses



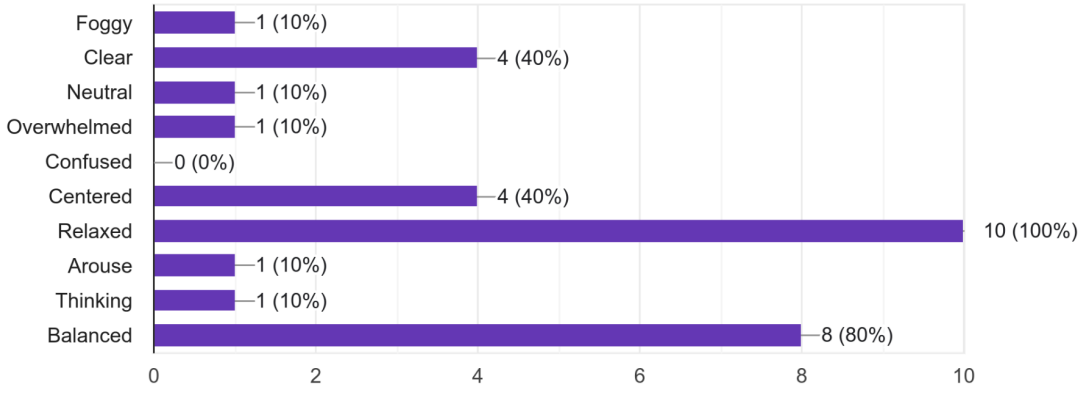
My stress levels reduced due to the Sound Session

14 responses



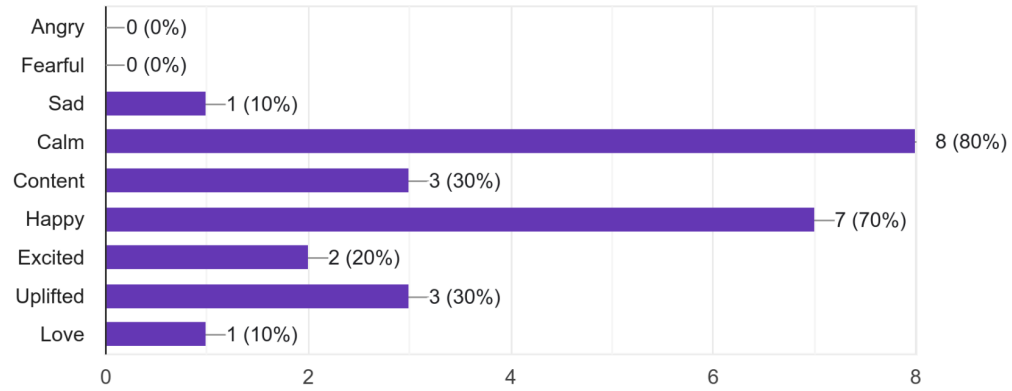
How was your state of mind after the session? You can mark more than one option

10 responses



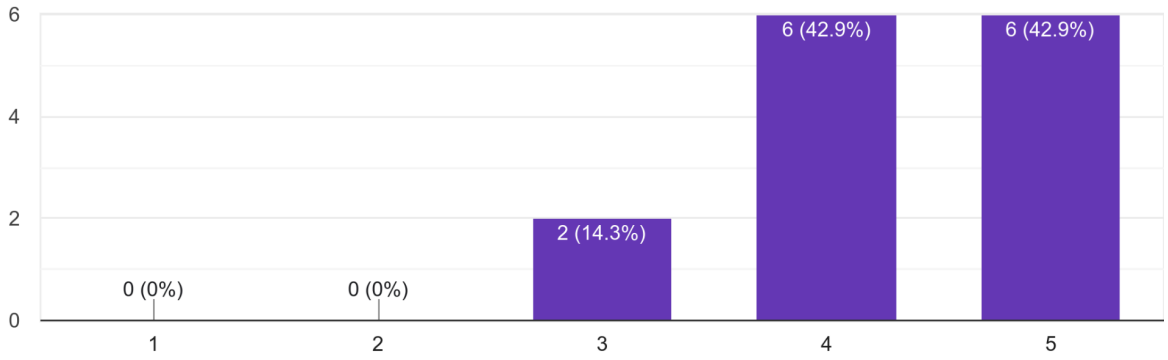
How was your emotional state after the session? You ca mark more than one option

10 responses



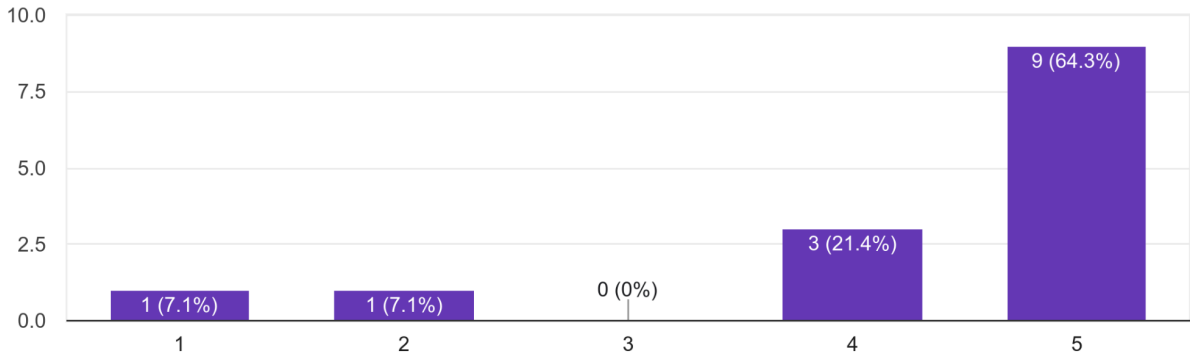
I noticed a positive change in the content of my thoughts after attending the Sound Session

14 responses



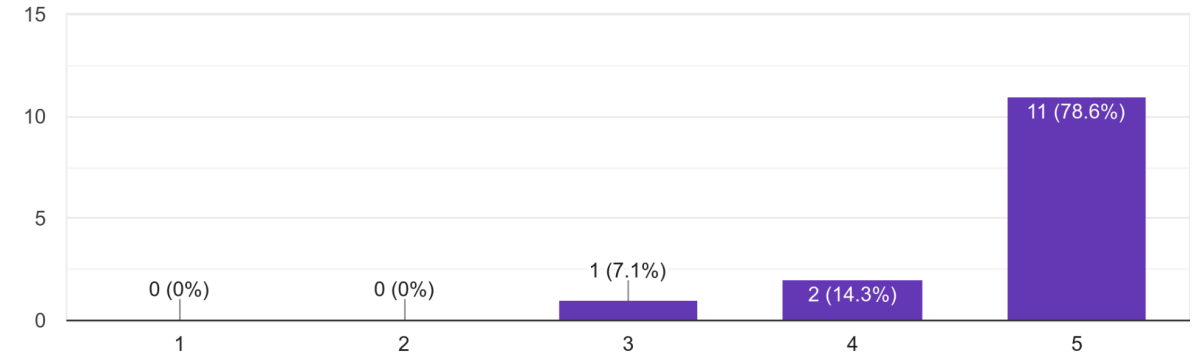
I gained new insights due to the Sound Session

14 responses



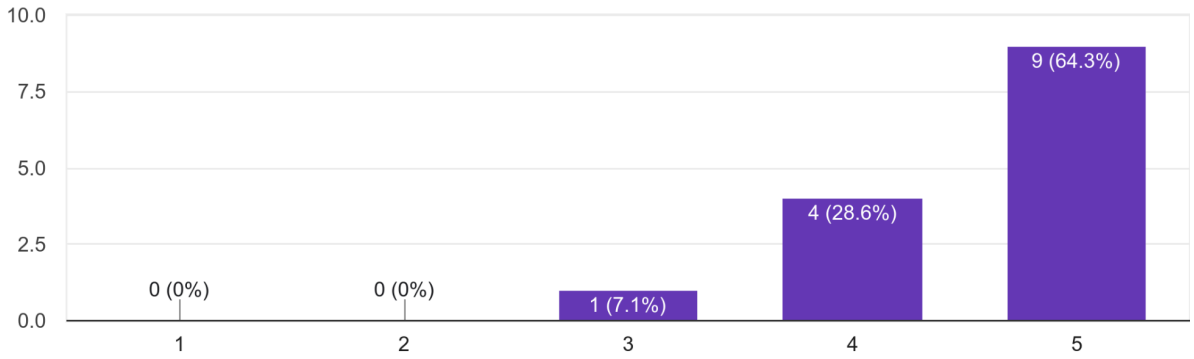
I felt more balanced and centered after the session

14 responses



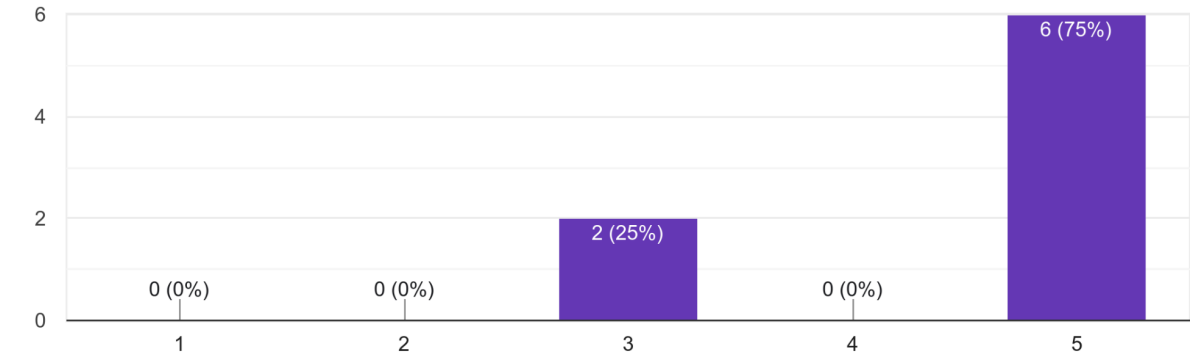
I felt a strong connection to myself due to the Sound Session

14 responses

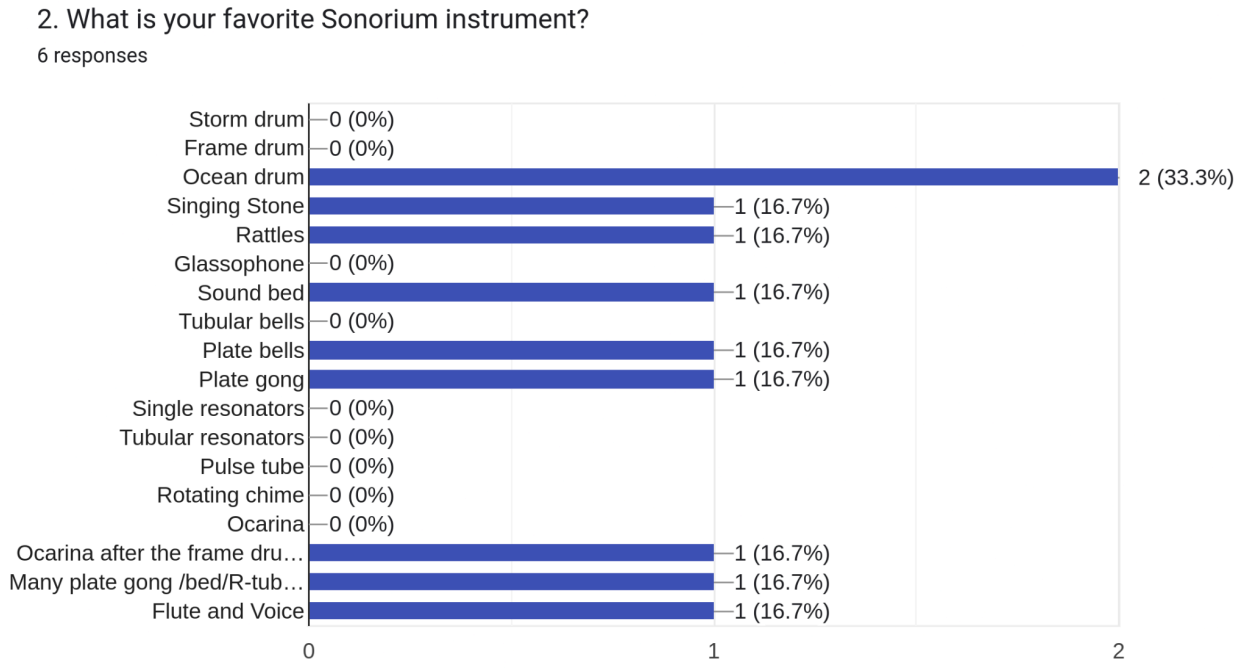


Do you feel any change when you think about your intention for the session?

8 responses

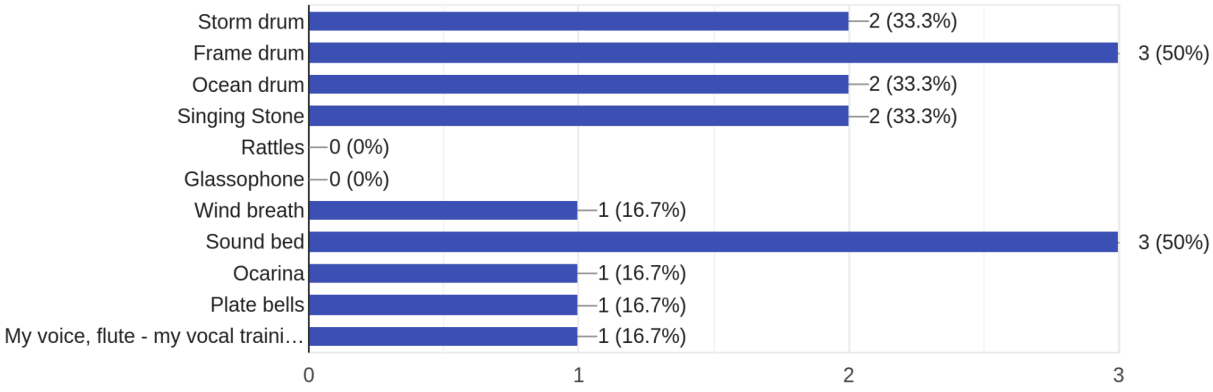


Some graphs from the practitioner' questionnaire:



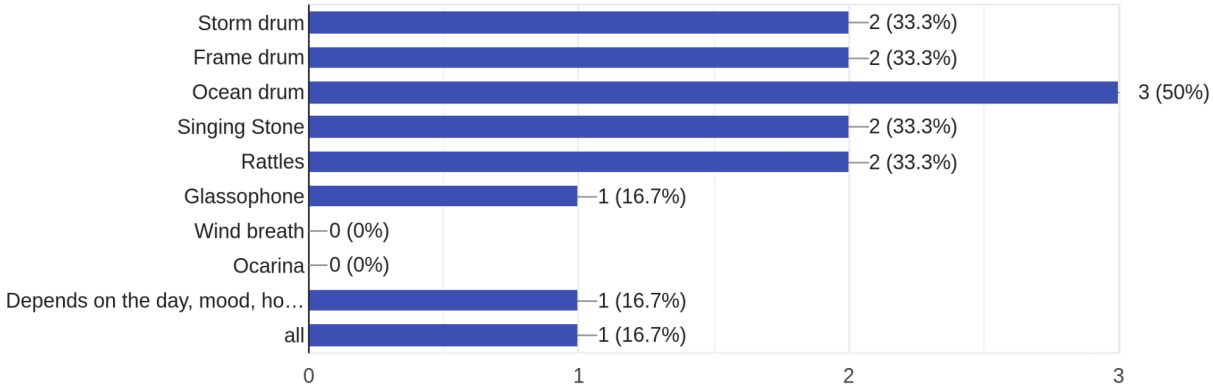
4. Is there an instrument that when you play it you are in a meditative space? (you can choose more than one option)

6 responses



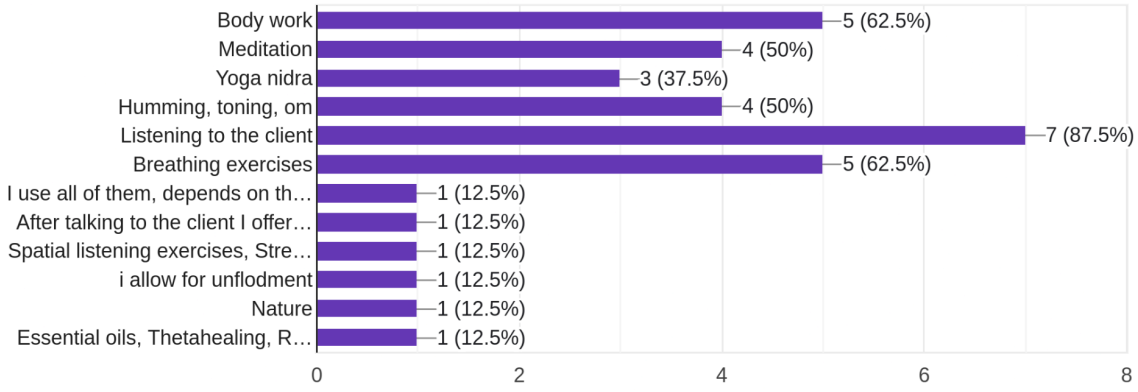
3. What is your favorite 5 element instrument? (you can choose more than one)

6 responses



16. At the beginning of the session, do you use any the following techniques to help the client to relax?

8 responses



Links for documentations:

Sonic Project Synopsis

Project Process Plan

Weekly Progress report

Mid Project - Progress Report

Mentor 24.05.2022

Mentor 17.6.22